

Dr. Chantell L. McDowell

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Executive Profile

Innovative nonprofit founder, educational strategist, STEM advocate, and technology leader with extensive experience in higher education, public libraries, youth development, instructional technology, and community-centered learning environments. Founder of MakeHERspace Inc., focused on empowering girls and underserved communities through technology, entrepreneurship, digital literacy, and innovation. Proven expertise in grant writing, makerspace development, strategic planning, organizational leadership, and educational program management.

Core Competencies

Nonprofit Leadership & Organizational Development	STEM & Makerspace Program Development
Grant Writing & Grant Management	Instructional Technology & Digital Learning
Strategic Planning & Operations Management	Community Engagement & Partnership Building
Youth Development & Educational Programming	Fundraising & Sponsorship Development

Professional Experience

Founder & Executive Director — MakeHERspace Inc.

2024 – Present | Charlotte, NC

- Founded and lead a nonprofit organization focused on STEM, makerspace learning, entrepreneurship, and youth empowerment.
- Develop strategic partnerships, fundraising initiatives, and educational programming.
- Lead branding, grant writing, curriculum development, and organizational growth strategies.

Instructional Technology Coordinator & Collections Development Librarian — Johnson C. Smith University

2016 – Present | Charlotte, NC

- Led instructional technology integration and makerspace initiatives supporting faculty and student innovation.
- Secured and managed grant-funded technology and library projects.
- Redesigned library learning spaces into innovative technology-centered collaboration environments.

Director of Youth Services — Worcester Public Library

2014 – 2015 | Worcester, MA

- Managed youth services operations and supervised a staff of 15 librarians and employees.
- Oversaw grant budgets exceeding \$750,000 across multiple branches.
- Led strategic initiatives focused on literacy, youth engagement, and community outreach.

Head Library Media Specialist — Charlotte-Mecklenburg Schools

2012 – 2013 | Charlotte, NC

- Developed and launched a new school library media and instructional technology program.
- Managed library operations, staffing, budgeting, and technology implementation.

Education

- Doctor of Arts in Organizational Leadership — Franklin Pierce University
- Master of Library & Information Science — Pratt Institute
- Bachelor of Arts in Media & Communications — SUNY Old Westbury
- Associate of Applied Arts in Journalism Technology

Publications

- Serving At-Risk Teens: Proven Strategies and Programs for Bridging the Gap (Co-Author)
- Improving Reading and Technology Skills in At-Risk Teens through Librarian-Led Mentoring Activities